

WA1: Collaboration Agreement

Background: Last semester, your team created and signed a Collaboration Agreement. This semester, you created and signed a Code of Conduct.

Prompt: Write a 1-page, single-spaced paper. Address these issues in your paper allocating one paragraph to each question:

1. How did your team approach these requirements?
2. What personality traits did you observe in your teammates?
3. If you could do it over, what would you do differently?

Response:

During the Fall 2025 semester, our capstone group was tasked with developing a collaboration agreement to establish clear expectations for how we would work together throughout the project. The purpose of this document was to promote effective communication, accountability, and mutual respect while ensuring the successful completion of our capstone deliverables. As a team, we agreed that text messaging would serve as our primary method of communication, with an expectation that all members respond within three hours whenever possible. To maintain organization and accessibility, we centralized all project-related materials in a shared Google Drive folder, allowing everyone to easily access assignments, documentation, and updates.

We also established guidelines for attendance, deadlines, and accountability. Team members agreed to notify the group in advance if they anticipated any delays or scheduling conflicts and to submit all work by the agreed-upon deadlines. In the event of conflicts or disagreements, we committed to addressing concerns directly and respectfully within the group. If issues could not be resolved internally, we agreed to escalate them to the course instructor or teaching assistant for guidance. Additionally, we outlined consequences for not adhering to the collaboration agreement. We chose “service to the group” as a form of accountability, which included completing additional tasks or providing support to other team members as needed.

When creating this document, our goal was to develop a standardized yet flexible framework that would allow us to meet project milestones efficiently while accommodating unforeseen challenges. Given our limited familiarity with the project’s domain, we recognized the importance of allowing room for adjustment as new obstacles arose. Throughout the process, I observed how individual personality traits influenced the roles each member selected. Leisha, who volunteered as team leader, managed communication with our sponsor, Merlion, and coordinated meetings, demonstrating strong organizational and communication skills. Maddie and Inaaya, serving as project managers, ensured that tasks stayed on schedule and deadlines were consistently met. Jade, as the designated documenter and reviewer, effectively captured

meeting notes and tracked progress, showcasing her attention to detail and ability to clarify project goals for the team.

If given the opportunity to revise our collaboration agreement, I would include more clearly defined team mission statements and values, as well as more specific criteria for what constitutes “service to the group.” I would also expand upon role-specific responsibilities to promote a more balanced distribution of work among team members.